

Rating Area 3: Northeast / Poconos

Hub: Scranton / Wilkes-Barre | Counties: Bradford, Carbon, Clinton, Lackawanna, Luzerne, Lycoming, Monroe, Pike, Sullivan, Susquehanna, Tioga, Wayne, Wyoming

21.5%	102%	443,024	160,000+
PID-approved avg. individual rate hike	avg. net premium increase, 2026	PA enrollees as of June 1, 2026	cumulative PA terminations

THE STATEWIDE PICTURE

The federal enhanced premium tax credits expired December 31, 2025, and Congress has not restored them; combined with the Pennsylvania Insurance Department's (PID) approved 21.5% average individual-market rate increase, Pennie reports the average net premium for the affected population rose 102% for 2026 (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025; Pennie, 2026a). Statewide, 85,000 people dropped Pennie coverage during Open Enrollment; as of June 1, 2026, cumulative cancellations exceed 160,000 and total enrollment stands at 443,024 (Pennie, 2026a, 2026b). Pennsylvania's own relief program, the Act 54 state subsidy, remains unfunded as the state budget missed its June 30, 2026 deadline for the fifth year running (Spotlight PA, 2026).

CARRIERS & RATES IN THIS AREA

PID's 2026 filings show this region with the widest spread between competing carriers statewide: Oscar Health Plan was approved for a 23.1% increase while Partners Insurance Company (Jefferson Health Plans) was approved for the only rate *decrease* in the entire individual market, at -10.1% (Pennsylvania Insurance Department, 2025; WITF, 2025). Both carriers, along with Health Partners Plans and Geisinger, operate across much of this footprint.

SHOPPING MATTERS MORE HERE THAN ALMOST ANYWHERE

When one carrier in your county cut rates while another raised them over 20%, staying on autopilot with last year's plan is the single costliest mistake available to you. Pennie's comparison tool will show every carrier licensed in your specific county for 2026 — use it before your plan auto-renews.

YOUR CONSUMER PROTECTIONS

If a directory error sends you out-of-network: 28 Pa. Code § 9.725 caps your liability at in-network cost-sharing, and Act 252 of 2023 presumes an undisclosed out-of-network balance bill illegal. The federal IDR process (45 C.F.R. § 149.510) is a *provider-vs-plan* tool only — you cannot file one yourself; use the protections above instead.

Enroll / compare plans: pennie.com or 1-844-844-8040	File a complaint: pa.gov/consumer or 1-866-722-6675
Free legal help: phlp.org or 1-800-274-3258	Medicare counseling: PA MEDI 1-800-783-7067

- SOURCES (APA)**
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 - Pennie. (2026b). *Affordability*. pennie.com/affordability
 - Pennsylvania Insurance Department. (2025, Oct. 14). *ACA 2026 health insurance rates*. pa.gov/agencies/insurance/newsroom/aca-2026-health-insurance-rates
 - Pennsylvania Insurance Department. (2025b). *Coverage areas, individual market, 2026*. pa.gov/agencies/insurance/posted-filings-reports-company-orders/product-and-rate-filings/aca-health-rate-filings/coverage-areas-individual-market
 - Spotlight PA. (2026, July 1). *PA's budget is late for the 5th year in a row*. spotlightpa.org
 - WITF. (2025, Oct. 17). *Health insurance rates... double-digit increase in 2026*. witf.org